

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 6: *Alienation from Self*¹

1. What is the real self? (155.1)
2. In the “devil’s pact”, what corresponds to the abandoning of the real self? (155.3)
3. When we are alienated from our self, what becomes impaired? (156.2)
4. Through neurosis, what parts of our material self can become alienated? (156.3)
5. List the characteristics of the phenomenon that is at the core of this alienation from the actual self? (157.2)
 - A.
 - B.
 - C.
6. What are some of things that the alive center of our real self provides? (157.2)
7. When strong and active, what does our real self enable us to do and with what result? (157.2)
8. What is the “actual self”? (158.1)
9. What is the “idealized self”? (158.1)

10. What is the “real self”? (158.1)
11. How do we know when we have felt or glimpsed the real or possible self? (158.1)
12. Describe the despair we experience when we’ve lost our real self. (158.2–159.1)
13. The very compulsive character of neurotic drives deprives a person of what? (159.2).
14. Through what active moves is alienation furthered? (159.3 and 160.3).
 - A.
 - B.
15. Through our neurotic claims, we insist that others do what? (159.3).
16. What is the outcome of insisting that others should be responsible for us? (160.1).
17. How does neurotic pride move us away from our real self? (160.2).
18. What becomes loathsome and terrifying for the neurotic? (160.3)
19. Why is alienation a devitalizing process? (161.2)
20. What ultimately governs feelings for a neurotic? (162.2)
21. When a neurotic suffers, who is mainly suffering? (163.2)
22. What can true suffering alone do for us? (163.3)

23. How does a general impoverishment of the emotional life show itself? (164.2)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
24. Our conscious attitude toward the disturbance of emotional dearth may be expressed in what ways? (164.3)
25. In what ways might existing emotional impoverishment be camouflaged? (164.3–165.3)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
26. What is one of the main characteristics of neurosis? (166.1)
27. What are the two implications of the shift in energies characteristic of neurosis? (166.2–3)
- A.
 - B.
28. Which of these weakened directive powers do you notice in your life? (167.2–168.2)
29. When directive powers are impaired or lost, what is another clearly discernible insufficiency? (168.3)
30. What makes it close to impossible to assume the only responsibility that matters – plain, simple honesty about ourselves and our lives? (169.3)

31. In what three ways does plain, simple honesty about ourselves and our lives operate? (169.3)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
32. Since taking responsibility for oneself does not preclude getting help, what does it imply? (169.3)
33. Even the best help from outside will not avail if the neurotic does not do what? (169.3)
34. Drawing from Dr. Horney's examples and your own experience, list some of the ways that you or others shift responsibility? (169.4–171.1)
35. What makes the real self visibly stronger? (171.2)
36. As the disintegrating impact of our neurotic conflicts grows, our shoulds with their pride and self-hates acquire what new function? (172.2)
37. What is created when we are not an active determining factor in our own lives? (172.3)
38. What does the outward direction of endeavors create for us? (173.2)
39. What happens when the pride system is undermined? (174.3)
40. When can the conflict between the pseudo-self and the real self turn into an open battle? (175.1)

Read Matthew 18:1–12.

The little child in this passage could represent the real self that has not yet been molded by the world, the flesh, and the devil (1 John 2:15–17; 1 Peter 5:8; Eph. 2:3). Jesus is teaching us how to handle the idealized self—cut it off, gouge it out, and enter Heaven, even if we feel crippled for a time. Heaven could begin right now if we would choose to live in complete orientation toward our real self and toward God.

“For the Son of Man came to seek and to save that which was lost.”² That is our business—to seek and save (or make whole) that which has been lost in ourselves. We are not alone in this process; Jesus is helping us. He is seeking the person He originally created us to be. As our real self becomes stronger, we can offer a safe environment to others and give them the opportunity to find their real self. We become partners with Jesus in the great mission of seeking and saving what has been lost.

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.